



PREGNANCY OPTIONS IN CANADA

NURS 280 MAY 28, 2026



CHOICES

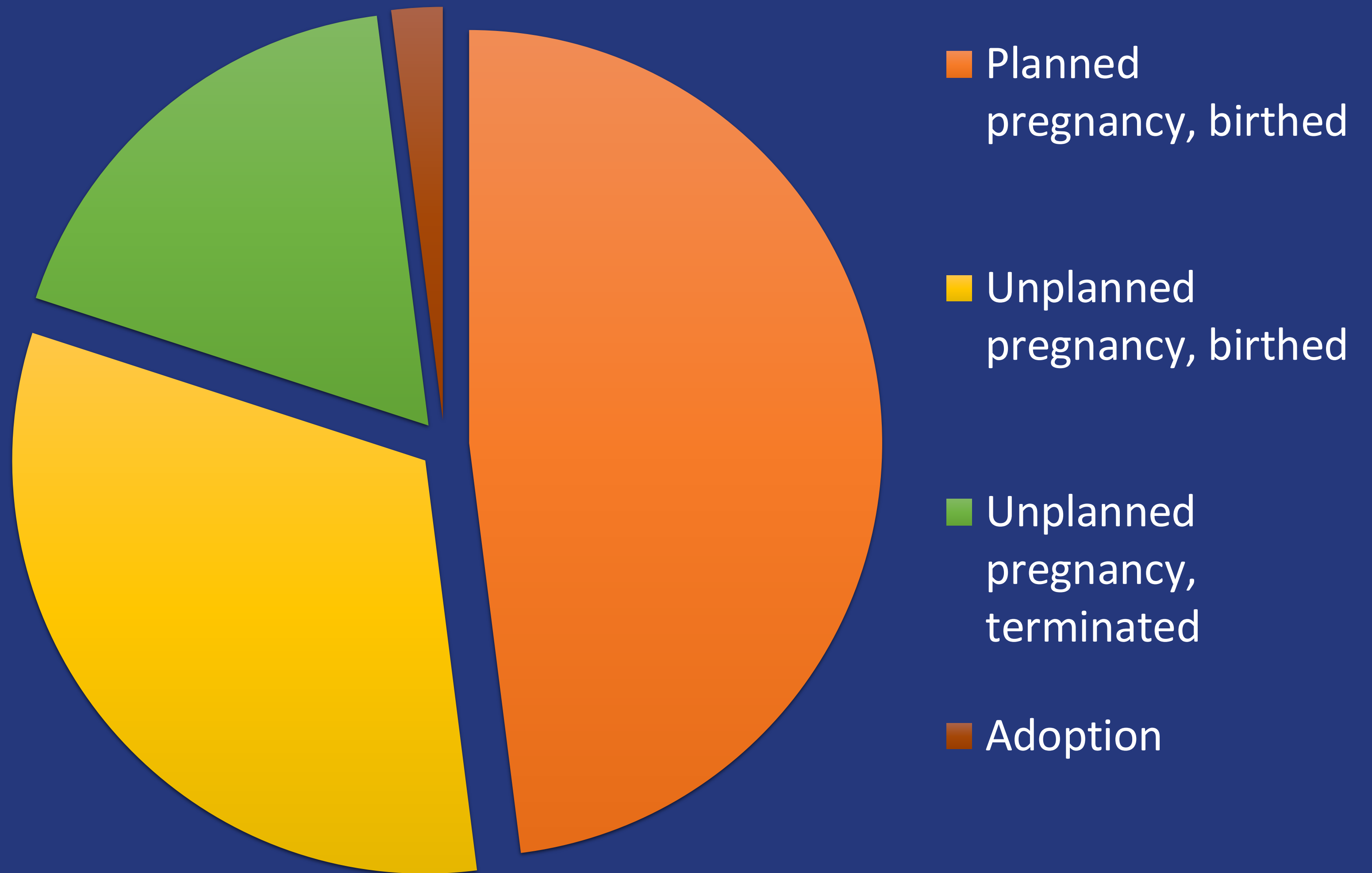


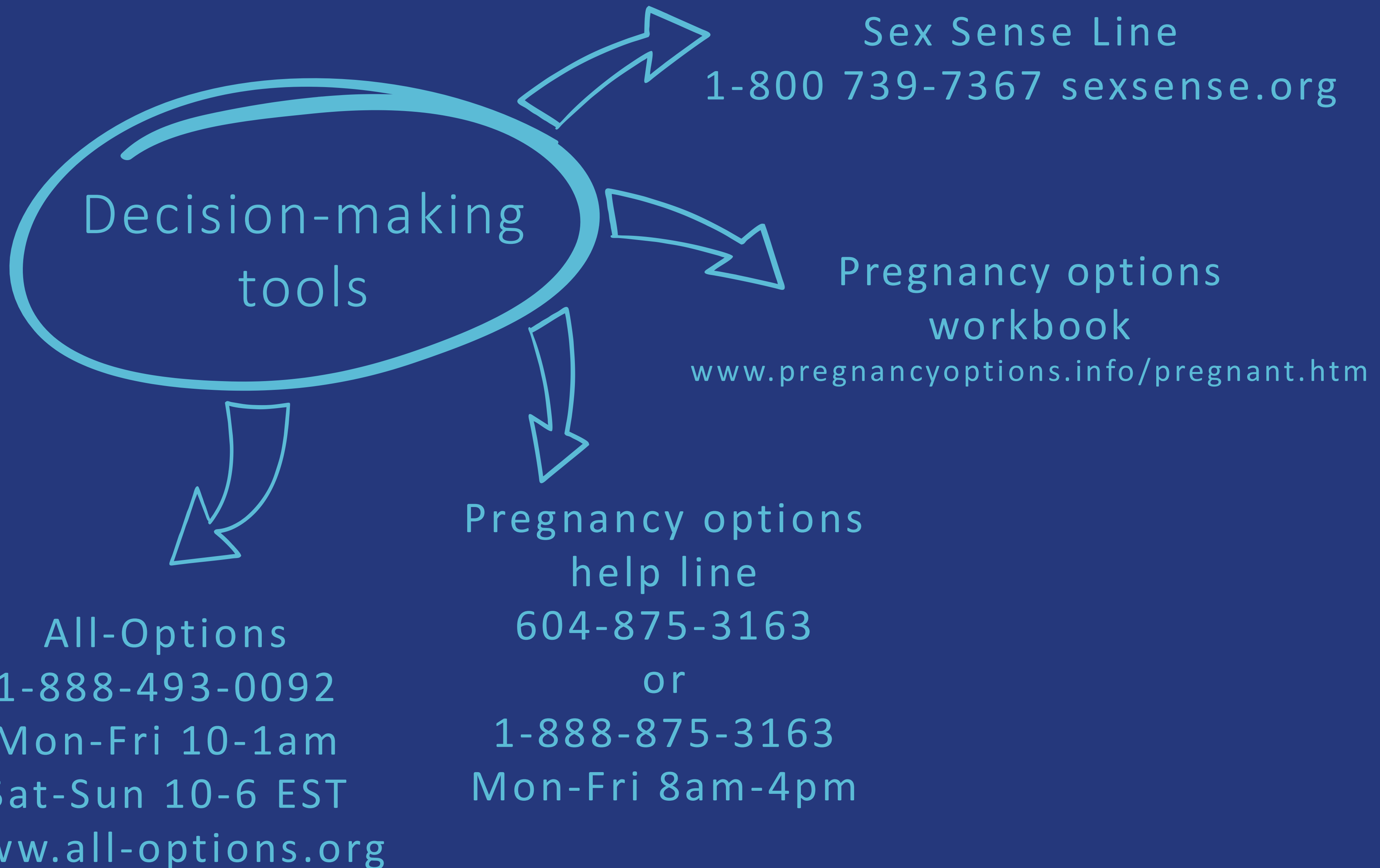
Continue pregnancy → parent child

Continue pregnancy → choose adoption

Access abortion services

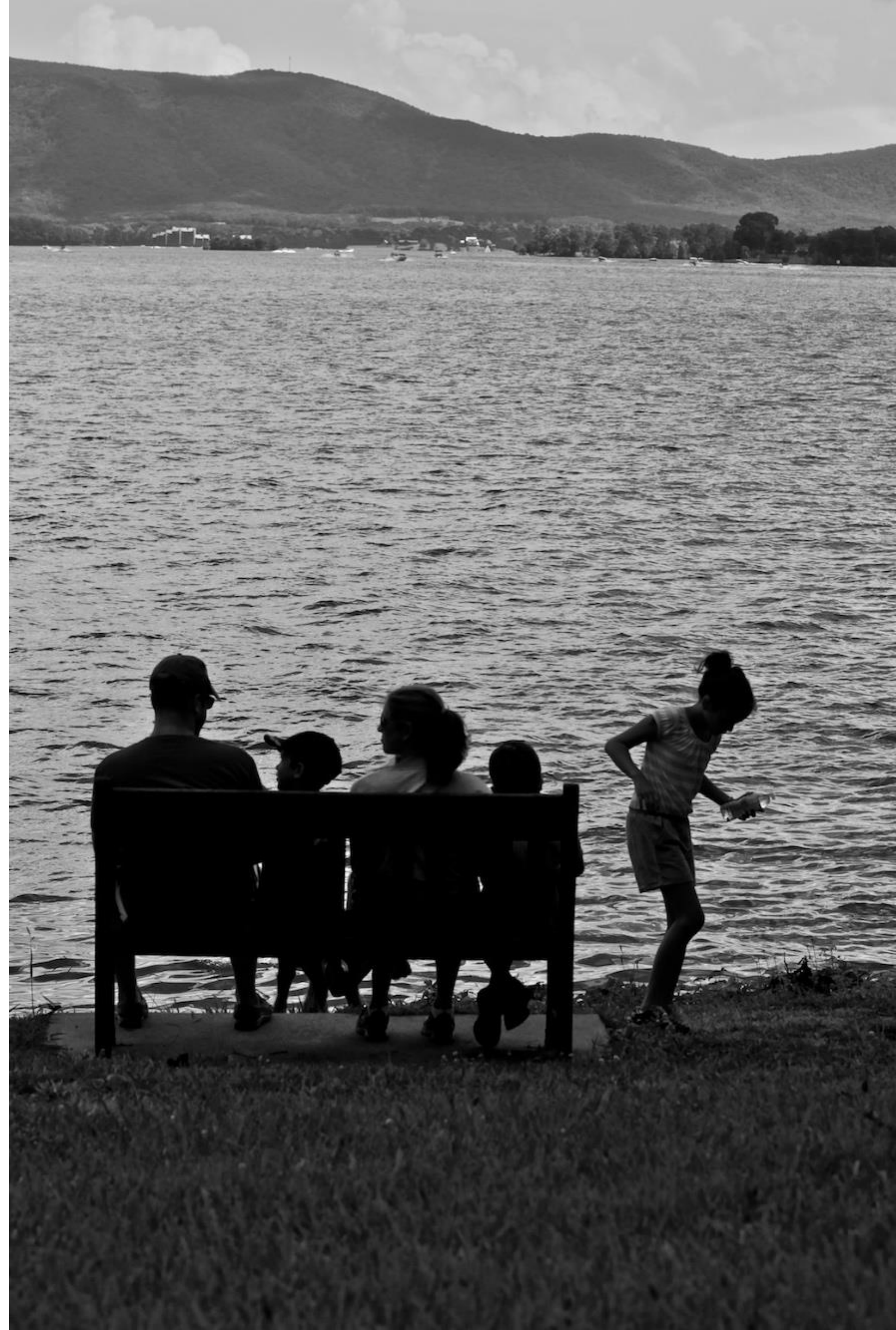
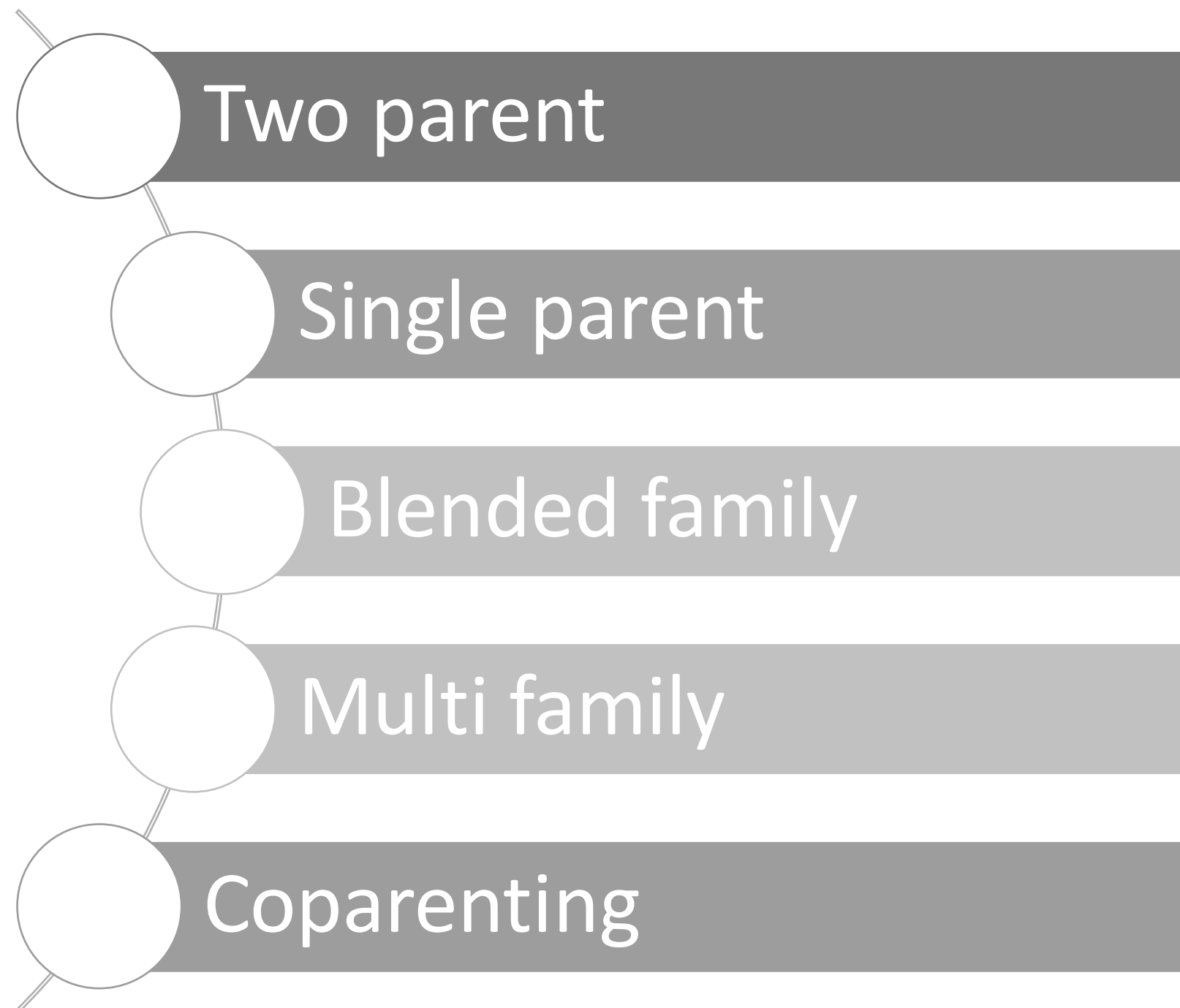






PARENTING

Families can look many different ways



Adoption

several types available:

Confidential

- no contact

- non-identifying info available

Open

- direct interaction

Direct

- someone you know adopts child

Custom

- Child raised according to custom of Indigenous community of the child

Adoption

- Consent needed from both birthparents (regardless of their age)
- Consent given 10 days after birth, and can be withdrawn within 30 days of birth
- Adoption details released on adoptee's 19th birthday. Disclosure Veto (pre-1996) and No Contact Declaration are available

Access to abortion in Canada

- Abortion illegal in Canada prior to 1969
- Criminal Law Amendment Act 1968-1969 made abortion legal if TAC approved

“There's no place for the state in the bedrooms of the nation.”

~ Pierre Elliott Trudeau, Justice Minister

Justice Minister Pierre Elliot Trudeau

Pierre Trudeau
Omnibus Interview

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pierre_Trudeau

Dr. Henry Morgentaler (1923-2013)



Morgentaler v. The Queen (1988)

"The decision of a woman to terminate her pregnancy falls within the class of protected decisions [because it will have] profound psychological, economic and social consequences for the pregnant woman... The right to reproduce or not to reproduce... is properly perceived as an integral part of modern woman's struggle to assert **her dignity and worth as a human being**... The purpose of [section 251] is to take the decision away from the woman and give it to a committee."

Justice Bertha Wilson

"Forcing a woman, by threat of criminal sanction, to carry a fetus to term unless she meets certain criteria unrelated to her own priorities and aspirations, is a profound interference with a woman's body and thus **a violation of her security of the person.**"

Justice Brian Dickson

ABORTION

Two types of abortions available in Canada:

- **Procedural abortion**
 - ✓ 5+ weeks pregnant
 - ✓ 1 or 2 visit to clinic (or hospital)
 - ✓ 10 minute procedure, 1 day off work
 - ✓ Dilation/suction
 - ✓ Covered by provincial/territorial health plans
- **Medication abortion (*Mifegymiso*—mifepristone & misoprostol)**
 - ✓ <10 weeks pregnant (<8 weeks from conception)
 - ✓ 2-3 visits to clinic (or telehealth)
 - ✓ Mifepristone given by mouth at clinic
 - ✓ Misoprostol taken at home (buccal)
 - ✓ Universal coverage everywhere but Nunavut

ABORTION FACTS

- 87% of abortions take place during first 12 weeks of pregnancy ¹
- In Canada, about a third of people who can get pregnant will have at least one abortion in their lifetime ²
- People of all ages have abortions in Canada, and this is evenly distributed across the lifespan ³
- About a third of people who have abortions in Canada are already parents ⁴

¹ ["Statistics - Abortion in Canada"](#) (PDF). Abortion Rights Coalition of Canada - Statistics Canada. 2020.

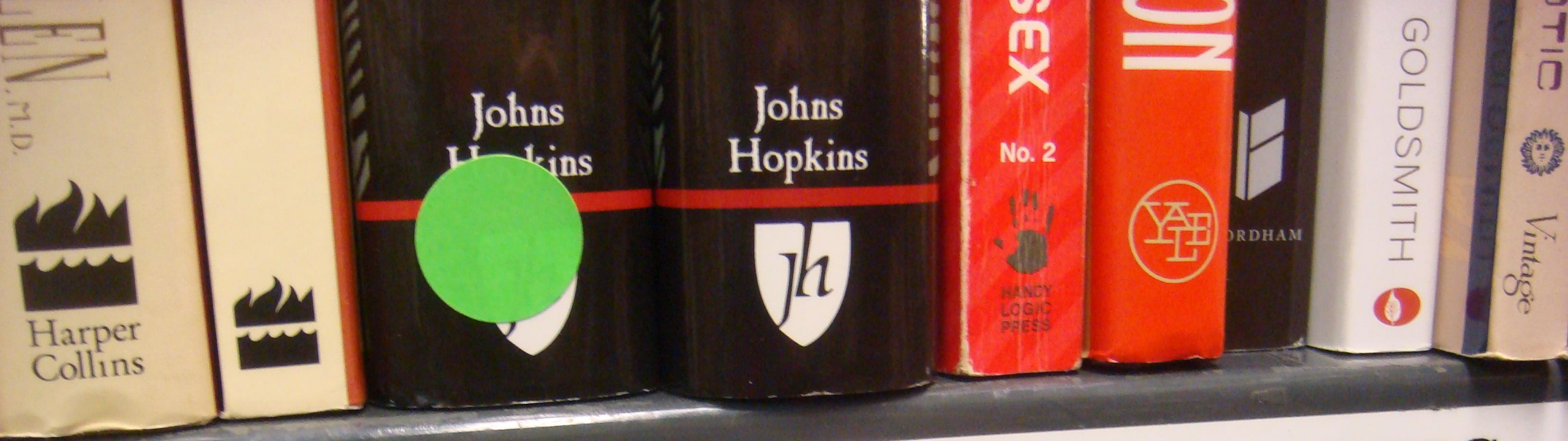
² Norman WV. Induced abortion in Canada 1974-2005: trends over the first generation with legal access. *Contraception*. 2012 Feb;85(2):185-91. doi: 10.1016/j.contraception.2011.06.009. Epub 2011 Aug 4. PMID: 22036474.

³ Induced Abortions Reported in Canada in 2021. (2023). *Canadian Institute for Health Information*.

⁴ Induced Abortions Reported in Canada in 2020. (2022). *Canadian Institute for Health Information*.

“I can take an anxious woman, who is in the biggest trouble she has ever experienced in her life, and by performing a five-minute operation, in comfort and dignity, I can give her back her life.”

Dr. Garson Romalis (1937-2014)



SEXUALITY CONTINUES



THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

